retiring early and moving to the mountains. Their initial vision of early retirement would put them in their fifties, a couple of decades away. But as they started to get specific about what they really wanted, they started to ask better questions. Liz shared that their conversations evolved to the point of asking, “Why don’t we do it now?”

This may seem like pie-in-the sky thinking to those unfamiliar with the principles of FI, but the ability to look at the world differently than the masses is what makes FI possible. As Liz noted, they didn’t have the financial resources to retire to the mountains immediately. However, she also noted, “When you have decided where you want to be in ten years, twenty years, in thirty years, it suddenly becomes very easy to line your finances up and to realize how much you’re going to need to save in order to facilitate that lifestyle.”

Most people drift through life and retire in their sixties or seventies because that’s what they see other people doing. Liz’s advice to others is to map out your goals in detail. *Then*, figure out how to make it happen. They did make it happen, retiring to their homestead in the woods of Vermont in their thirties.

For some people, motivation to pursue FI can simply mean having the freedom to slow down and experience life. Jay, a